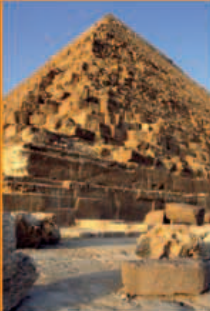


RULERS AND HIERARCHIES

3000–700 BCE

3000 BCE		2750 BCE		2500 BCE		2250 BCE	
c. 3000 Beginning of Early Dynastic period of Mesopotamian city-states, including Sumerian-speaking Uruk and Ur. Start of Bronze Age in southeast Europe—in Minoan Crete and Cyclades islands of Greece. ▼ Administrative tablet, Uruk, Mesopotamia		c. 2750 First Chinese bronze artifacts. c. 2700 Mythical king Gilgamesh may have ruled Uruk in Mesopotamia. Silk weaving practiced in China.			c. 2340 Sargon founds and rules the city of Akkad, uniting city-states of Mesopotamia into the first empire. Sargon of Akkad ▼		c. 2100 3rd Dynasty of Ur revives Sumerian civilization in southern Mesopotamia; King Ur-Nammu of Ur builds a ziggurat (stepped tower), now typical of Mesopotamian architecture, while renovating Ur's temple.
		  	c. 2600 Rich array of grave goods buried at Royal Graves at Ur, Mesopotamia, indicate trade links extending as far as the Indus. 2613 Beginning of 4th Dynasty in Egypt—the age of the first true pyramids.	▲ Stamp seal from Mohenjo Daro, Indus Valley c. 2500 Indus Valley civilization reaches its peak. Metalworking, in the form of copper, reaches across Europe to British Isles.		▲ Pepy II, 6th-Dynasty Egyptian pharaoh c. 2200 First pottery in South America. 2181 Egyptian 6th Dynasty ends with collapse of Old Kingdom; First Intermediate Period of Egypt begins.	
c. 2900 Early marble figurines made by the Cycladic culture of Greece. c. 2800 End of Early Harappan phase of Indus Valley civilization, which began c. 3300 BCE. Cycladic figure ►		▲ Standard of Ur 2686 3rd Dynasty of Egypt heralds the beginning of the Egyptian Old Kingdom.	c. 2550 Outer stone circle erected at Stonehenge, Britain. c. 2540 Great Pyramid of Khufu built in Giza, near Memphis, Egypt.	c. 2500–2350 Border conflict between Umma and Lagash in Mesopotamia is earliest international controversy recorded. c. 2500–2350 Destruction of city of Ebla in Syria conserves the palace archives.		c. 2100 In Mesopotamia, decline of Akkadian empire founded by Sargon; rise of regional rulers of city states, notably Gudea of Lagash.	Gudea of Lagash ▲ 2040 Mentuhotep II, ruler of Thebes, unites Upper and Lower Egypt and initiates Egypt's Middle Kingdom. ▼ Ziggurat of Ur
Caral ruins ► c. 3000–2750 First cities develop in South America; several settlements featuring temple complexes, such as Caral, emerge in coastal Peru.		c. 2650 Step Pyramid of Djoser built at Saqqara; start of great period of pyramid-building in Egypt. c. 2600 Evidence for use of plow, Indus Valley. Great Pyramid of Khufu, Giza ►		▲ Shipbuilding, 5th-Dynasty Egyptian tomb c. 2300 Beginning of Bronze Age in rest of Europe.			